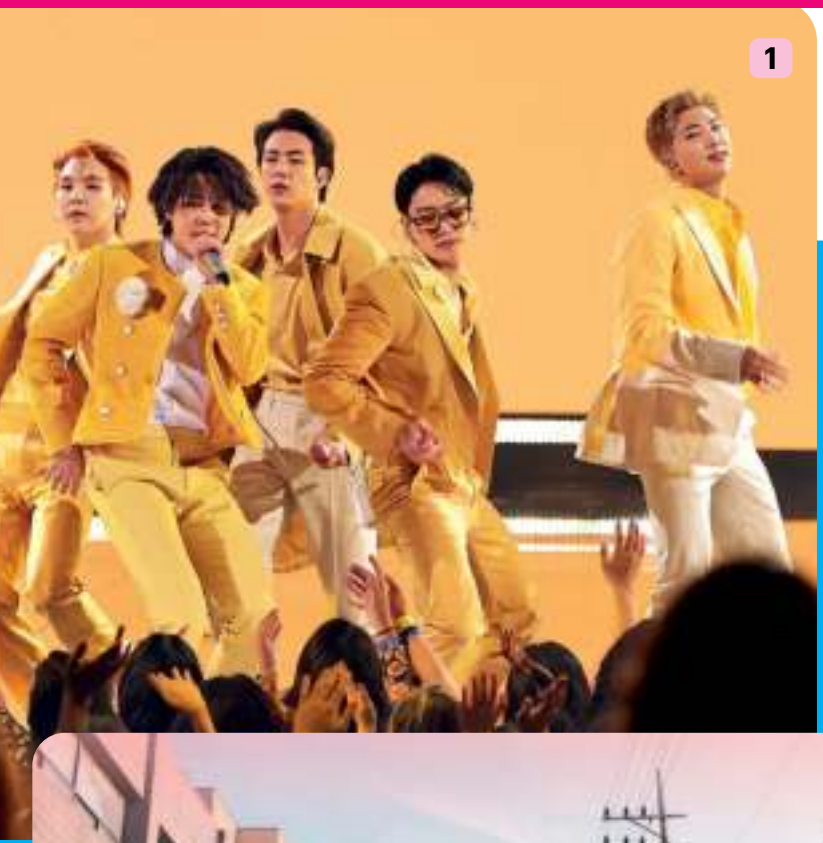


1



2

Courtesy: YG Entertainment



3

Korea'. Young fans are flocking to Korean photo booths, posing with quirky props and sporting styles inspired by their idols. Many swear by the rigorous 10-step Korean skincare routine that promises the coveted Korean "glass skin". Many are also learning the language, to avoid any losses in translation. Korean, according to a 2022 study by language learning platform Duolingo, is among the top five most popular choices for aspiring Indian polyglots. The world is taking note, too, as the Oxford English Dictionary added seven new words to its Korean list, among them 'dalgona' (a sugary candy) and 'maknae' (the youngest member of a group or family).

Korean soft power has definitely come to stay in India. In the 2024 Overseas Hallyu Survey

K-POP'S EMBRACE OF FEMININITY AND FLUID EXPRESSION ARE A BIG PART OF WHY IT RESONATES WITH WOMEN AS WELL AS THE LGBTQIA+ COMMUNITY

conducted by the Korean ministry of culture, sports and tourism and the Korean Foundation for International Cultural Exchange, India featured among the top countries where 84.5 per cent of the respondents said they spent an average of 18.6 hours a month on Korean content, way above the global average of 11.6 hours. Food topped the list (64.7 per cent), followed by travel to Korea (61.8 per cent), dining at Korean restaurants (61.4 per cent), cosmetics (54 per cent) and apparel (52.8 per cent). We do not know the exact number of K-fans in India, but it's not a risky wager to say tens of millions, judging from telltale online footfalls. Think of it as a large, steaming Korean spa with an eclectic clientele. Humble, ornery folks as well as the